

EXCEL DOUGHNUT CHART

Part-to-whole in a dashboard-friendly style

05

WHEN TO USE

- Data has **2-5 categories** that add up to a **whole**.
- Answers: **How is the total divided?**
- Use it on **dashboards**: the centre hole can show a key total or KPI.

BUSINESS QUESTION

- What share of customers is in each segment?
- Which segment is our biggest customer group?
- How big is Enterprise compared with the rest?

DATA EXAMPLE

	A	B
1	Segment	Customers
2	Consumer	5,200
3	Small Business	2,600
4	Enterprise	1,200
5	Education	1,000

DATA ANALYST USE CASE

Example: **Customer Segmentation**

QUESTION

Who are our customers?

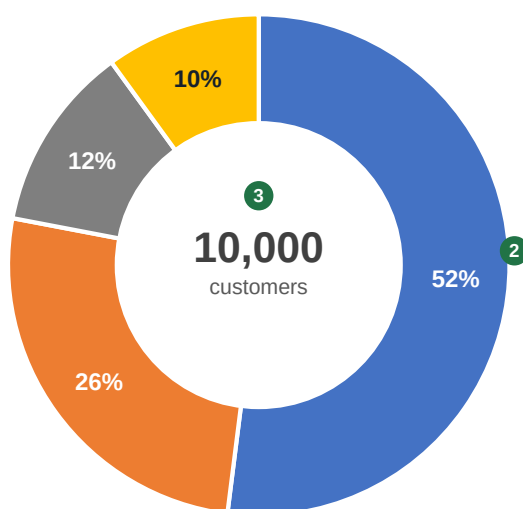
CHART

Doughnut Chart

INSIGHT

Consumers make up 52% of customers, while Enterprise is only 12%.

1 Customer Segment Share



4 Consumer Small Business Enterprise Education

1 Chart Title 2 Data Labels (%) 3 Centre Total 4 Legend

HOW TO CREATE IT IN EXCEL



- 1 Select the data, including the headers (A1:B5).
- 2 Go to the **Insert** tab and open the **Charts** group.
- 3 Click **Insert Pie or Doughnut Chart > Doughnut**.
- 4 Add a **Chart Title**, then **Format Data Series > Doughnut Hole Size** (about 55%).
- 5 **Format**: add percentage labels and place the total in a centre text box.

DO / DON'T

DO ✓

- ✓ Keep to 5 segments or fewer
- ✓ Show percentages on the ring
- ✓ Use the centre for the total or KPI
- ✓ Use consistent, distinct colours

DON'T ✗

- ✗ Use many thin slices
- ✗ Rely on the ring to compare sizes
- ✗ Use it for trends over time
- ✗ Use clashing or neon colours



DATA ANALYST TIP

Use a doughnut when the total matters, and put it in the centre.

Great for dashboards. When exact comparison matters, use a bar chart instead.